Chinese polysilicon and silicon wafer producer, GCL-Poly Energy Holdings, is completing a 130,000 MT polysilicon plant outside Kashgar in Sinkiang.[10] When completed, it could become the world's leading low-cost, high-quality polysilicon production base for modified Siemens method polysilicon manufacturing.

Chinese Hunt for Water

Is this quest for water one of the driving forces behind China's Belt and Road Initiative in Pakistan? As has been shown in Chapter 7, way back in 1954, China encroached into Indian territory in Aksai Chin, which is an extension of the Taklamakan Desert and occupied the whole of Aksai Chin[11] ostensibly to build a road linking Sinkiang and Tibet, both of which the country had recently annexed. But even then, the farsighted Chinese strategists were interested in the Shaksgam Valley, which is home to over 242 glaciers and considered to be the most heavily glaciated region in the world outside of the two poles.[12] Aksai Chin provides alternate access to the Shaksgam Valley.[13] The Shaksgam Valley fell into Pakistan's lap in 1947 as a consequence of British perfidy in orchestrating the Gilgit rebellion during Partition. The Chinese and Pakistanis were in secret negotiations in 1962 when China invaded India. Their border deal and the transfer of the Shaksgam Valley to China took place in early 1963.

But even before the Sino-Pak deal on the Shaksgam Valley was signed, China had surveyed plans for a transportation corridor stretching from the Chinese border to Pakistan's deep-water ports on the Arabian Sea. It was in this connection that Pakistan purchased Gwadar from Oman in 1958. In fact, Oman had first offered this to India and Nehru turned it down. After the purchase of Gwadar, the Chinese started construction of the Karakoram Highway in 1959. Warning bells should have been sounded in India,[14] but nobody seemed to be worried. In fact, in 1960, India signed the Indus Waters Treaty thereby gifting Pakistan a lion's share of the waters from the six major rivers of north India.